Neal T. Gillespie

Austin, TX 78729 • nealtgill@gmail.com • (513) 807-1705 • linkedin.com/in/neal01

October 16, 2026

Hiring Committee
Texas A&M University Libraries
College Station, TX

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Specialist I position. I have spent the last four years in nonprofit development, but the work I have gravitated toward in every role has been the same, which is organizing information so that other people can find it. I am now moving toward librarianship in earnest, and I would like to do that work in an actual library.

Much of what this position involves is work I have already done. As a student registrar at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law, I staffed the service window as the first person students talked to, which meant answering questions, explaining procedures that were not always obvious, and sending people to the right office when the answer was not mine to give. I also processed more than five hundred exam records and transcripts in PeopleSoft, and I proctored exams, including individually proctored sittings for students with accommodations. It taught me that front desk work is mostly patience and accuracy, and that people usually arrive at the desk already frustrated.

Before my current job I spent six months at the University of Austin, and part of that work put me inside their library. I handled intake and documentation for donated collections, including a complete Harvard Classics set, and I was the person who walked visitors through the library and answered their questions about what was in it. It was a small piece of a development job, but it was the piece I kept wanting more of, and it is most of the reason I am writing to you now.

In my current role I manage direct mail production for Young Americans for Liberty, where I also oversee our physical archive of printed materials. That means intake, organization, shelving, and retrieval across several years of campaigns. When I found that nobody could locate anything in it, I built a digital reading room indexed so staff can pull what they need without asking me first. Working with a physical collection and the finding aid that makes it usable is the part of my job I enjoy most.

Outside of work I founded the Free Knowledge Library at freeknowledgelibrary.net, an archive that preserves political literature from across the ideological spectrum. I built it because material disappears quietly when it becomes inconvenient, and because I believe what the ALA believes about access to information and the freedom to read. Preservation is not endorsement. I designed the classification scheme and built the database and catalog behind it. I also built StateTrack at statetrack.net, a searchable public database of state campaign finance records and legislative activity covering all fifty states, which taught me what it takes to normalize messy records into something a person can actually search.

I plan to pursue a master's degree in library and information science within the next few years, and I have started a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College along with the ALA's Library Support Staff Certification. Before I commit to a graduate program, I want real experience on a service desk, in the stacks, and in a working library. That is honestly why this position interests me more than roles that would pay better. I understand the schedule is Sunday through Thursday overnight, and I am prepared for it.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie